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Bazaar

ASUS Zenbook UX305

Almost a premium ultraportable

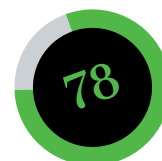
The ASUS Zenbook UX305 gets a lot of things right. It's a slim, trim 13-inch ultraportable that can be easily mistaken for more than what it's worth, and we mean that in the best possible way. Right from its unboxing, the first thing that catches your attention is the screen lid, which has a finely textured pattern of concentric circles – “spun metal hairline details” characteristic of all Zenbooks – that looks pretty cool to touch and on the eye. Hold the notebook up and it's quite light at 1.2 kg, comfortably sitting inside any backpack without a hitch. You can barely feel its weight! And at 1.2 cm thin, it's easily one of the thinnest laptops around. All the anorexic dimensions does affect the notebook's build quality – its screen feels a bit flimsy in comparison to the 13-inch MacBook Air, for instance, and it lacks that reassurance factor that an expensive, well-built ultrabook comes with. Not a dealbreaker, though, all this means is that you just have to be extra careful about this notebook's screen – make sure it doesn't flex or bend too much, when it's placed in your backpack make sure no unnecessary stress is falling on its spine.

In terms of its keyboard and trackpad, the Zenbook UX305 is reminiscent of the MacBook Air to a certain extent. The typing experience is certainly quite good, no complaints whatsoever, if anything its single-slab trackpad is something that most prospective users will need to get used to, as the unit we received had slightly clunky trackpad – nothing to spoil the party, but enough to make you wonder if you pressed or clicked its right / left area with enough force or not.

Apart from coming with 5th generation Intel Core M processor, it has 256GB SSD storage built in. At one hand the processor is designed to save power and not be a speed demon, while on the other hand the native SSD lends an element of lightning-paced agility on Windows 8. As an overall performer, this notebook does very well in terms of built-in battery life (4 hours and 40 minutes on high performance preset) and audio performance (thanks to B&O Tech audio), but it strictly does OK (which means nothing great) in terms of its core CPU performance. From a performance perspective,



Price
₹50,999



Features.....	80
Performance.....	78
Design.....	78
Value.....	77

Specifications

Screen: 13.3-inch, 1920x1080 pixels; **CPU:** Dual-core Intel Core M-5Y10c, 0.8 GHz (998MHz); **RAM:** 4GB DDR3; **Storage:** 256GB SSD; **Graphics:** Intel HD 5300; **Wireless:** Wi-Fi 802.11n + Bluetooth; **Connectivity:** USB 3.0 x 3, mini HDMI, SD Card slot; **Webcam:** HD 720p; **Weight:** 1.2 kg

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the Zenbook UX305 is for anyone who desires a sleek, good-looking ultrabook with very good battery life and fast-storage related transfer speeds. It also does a good job of playing multimedia content, thanks to its Full HD IPS screen. However, if we had to rate its screen against the MacBook Air or HP Spectre x360, the Zenbook UX305's screen would come in at third place, which is not bad at all. But – important thing to remember – it also costs considerably lesser than the aforementioned Apple and HP slim notebooks.

Another great performance aspect of the ASUS Zenbook UX305 is that it runs cool during most of its operational use. We routinely saw temperatures hovering between the 40°C to 50°C, from peak to mild load, which is better than most laptops we can speak about.

To summarize, there's a lot to like about the ASUS Zenbook UX305. It's sleek, ultraportable, and has fast-paced performance elements. Look at its feature list in the spec sheet alongside and you'll notice that it has pretty much all bases covered, if not more. The only thing it misses out on are a strong CPU, ethernet slot, discrete GPU and better build quality. But at 50k, we can't ask for the moon! We have to be realistic. If you're tired of your laptop, this is a nice ultraportable upgrade priced aggressively.

This is one of the slimmest laptops we have reviewed

Jayesh Shinde